

Old Names of Countries

There are many such countries in the world that have had their names changed due to circumstances or time. ***Ghana** was the first country in Africa to gain its independence from British colonialism on 6th March, 1957. Its former name was Gold Coast. *The country of **Suriname** in South America was earlier known as Dutch Guiana. ***Zimbabwe** was formerly known as Southern Rhodesia. Earlier Zimbabwe was a British colony. The capital of Zimbabwe is Harare which was officially called Salisbury until 1982.

***Taiwan** was earlier known as Formosa. * Similarly **Myanmar** was known as Burma (or the Union of Burma), **Thailand** as Siam and **Iraq** as Mesopotamia.

Former Names of Countries/Regions	
Current Name	Old Name
Japan	Nippon
Iran	Persia
Lesotho	Basutoland
Ethiopia	Abyssinia
Botswana	Bechuanaland
Djibouti	French Somaliland
Zambia	Northern Rhodesia
Madagascar	Malagasy
Indonesia	Nusantara
Hawaii Island	Sandwich Island
Malawi	Nyasaland
Netherlands	Holland
Belize	British Honduras
Cambodia	Democratic Kampuchea
Zimbabwe	Southern Rhodesia
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Zaire
Malaysia	Federation of Malaya

1. Match List-I and List-II and choose the correct answer from the codes given below-

List-I (Old Name)	List-II (New Name)
A. Siam	1. Taiwan
B. Formosa	2. Myanmar
C. Mesopotamia	3. Thailand
D. Burma	4. Iraq

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	3	4
(b)	4	2	1	3

(c) 1 3 2 4

(d) 3 1 4 2

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The correct match of old names and new names is as follows

(New Name)	(Old Name)
Taiwan	- Formosa
Myanmar	- Burma (or Union of Burma)
Thailand	- Siam
Iraq	- Mesopotamia

2. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Current Name	Old Name
(a) Harare	- Salisbury
(b) Ethiopia	- Abyssinia
(c) Ghana	- Dutch Guiana
(d) Kinshasa	- Leopoldville

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Except for option (c) other pairs are correctly matched. The old name of Ghana is Gold Coast, not Dutch Guiana. Ghana was the first country on the African continent to achieve independence (on March 6, 1957) from the British colony. Dutch Guiana is known as Suriname.

3. Zimbabwe was earlier known as –

(a) Southern Rhodesia	(b) Gold Coast
(c) Ivory Coast	(d) Belgian Congo

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Zimbabwe was earlier known as Southern Rhodesia. It was a British colony. Harare, the capital of Zimbabwe, was previously known as Salisbury.

International Border Lines

*It is very important to know about the international boundary lines between major countries.

*The **Rio Grande** is one of the principal rivers in the United States and Mexico. It forms part of United States-Mexico border. ***Lake Victoria** of Africa also known as Lake Nyanza is the second largest freshwater lake in the world. The Lake's administrative rights are shared by three countries Kenya, Uganda and Tanzania. The lake thus creates an international border between Uganda-Tanzania, Uganda-Kenya and Kenya-Tanzania. * The **McMahon Line** is the effective boundary between India and China. India claims the

McMahon Line to be a permanent line of the settlement of borders whereas China claims it to be temporary in nature. China does not even recognize the Shimla Treaty.

***The Maginot Line** constructed after the 1st World War is named after the French Minister of War Andre Maginot. The line was built near France's eastern border with Germany and the annexed countries. * **The Alpine Line** or **Little Maginot Line** separates the borders of France and Italy. ***Radcliffe Line** is the boundary demarcation line between India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh. *The **49th parallel** (49°N Latitude) north forms the United States–Canada border. *The **38th parallel** (38°N latitude) north forms the border between North and South Korea. * The **Oder-Neisse Line** is the basis of the international border between Germany and Poland. * The **Durand Line** is the international border between Pakistan and Afghanistan and between India and Afghanistan. * The **Hindenburg Line** was a German defensive position built during the winter of 1916-17 on the Western Front during the First World War. It forms the border between Germany, Belgium and France. * The **Mannerheim Line** forms the borderline between Poland and Russia.

1. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------------|
| (a) Radcliffe line | - India and Pakistan |
| (b) Maginot line | - France and Germany |
| (c) Durand line | - Bangladesh and India |
| (d) Hindenburg line | - Belgium and Germany |

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

The international border between India and Pakistan (India and Bangladesh) has been determined by the Radcliffe Line. The Maginot Line separates the border of France from Germany and the annexed countries, while the Durand Line determines the border between India-Afghanistan and Afghanistan-Pakistan. Similarly, the Hindenburg Line between Germany, Belgium and France is an international demarcation limit. Hence, option (c) is not correctly matched.

2. Which of the following rivers forms international border?

- | | |
|----------------|-----------|
| (a) Indus | (b) Nile |
| (c) Rio Grande | (d) Rhine |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2003

Ans. (*)

Rio Grande river separates the southern border of the United States of America from Mexico. It was identified in 1845. The basin of this river is spread across the United States of America and Mexico. Rhine river forms the border between France and Germany.

3. Rio Grande river makes boundary between –

- | | |
|----------------------------|---|
| (a) Canada and USA |] |
| (b) Mexico and USA | |
| (c) Mexico and Guatemala | |
| (d) Guatemala and Honduras | |

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Which one of the following lakes forms as an International boundary between Tanzania and Uganda?

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| (a) Chad | (b) Malawi |
| (c) Victoria | (d) Zambezi |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Lake Victoria is also known as Victoria Nyanza. It is the world's second largest freshwater lake by surface area. Tanzania, Uganda and Kenya have administrative authority over this lake. Lake Victoria forms an international border between Uganda-Tanzania, Uganda-Kenya and Kenya-Tanzania.

5. Consider the map given below-



The dotted (broken) line in the map is the-

- | |
|--|
| (a) Durand line |
| (b) Mac Mahon line |
| (c) Line of demarcation between India and Pakistan suggested by the Boundary Commission (1947) |
| (d) Route followed by the Young husband Expedition |

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

After observing the map of Pakistan and Afghanistan it is clear that the dotted line indicates the border line of Pakistan and Afghanistan. This borderline is known as the Durand Line.